India is not a leader in establishing a commercial presence abroad in these areas, except in ICT services.

India's Services Export Basket is Very Narrow

The global trade system monitors exports and imports for fifteen groups of services. According to data of 2019–20 from Services Export Promotion Council (SEPC) there are only four major service groups that account for as much as 90 per cent of exports in India: IT services; business services; travel; and transport. In the areas of top global services export (distribution services and financial services) and rapidly growing new areas (IP services, construction, education, etc.), India has an insignificant presence and share. ICT services (45 per cent), business services (21 per cent), travel (14 per cent) and transport (10 per cent) were the four largest service exports of India.

CSSS covers twelve sectors that traverse nine of the fifteen groups in which export of services is classified globally. These are tourism and hospitality (part of the tourism group with a global share of 8 per cent); medical value travel and healthcare services (0.4 per cent); transport and logistics including maritime transport (part of transport, 12 per cent); accounting and finance, including auditing and book-keeping; legal; construction and related engineering including architectural services; business services and maintenance and repair (part of other business services, 4 per cent, and professional services, 3.4 per cent); audio-visual and entertainment services; IT/BPM and other services (telecommunications, computer services and audio-visuals, 13 per cent); environmental services (0.2 per cent); financial services (19 per cent); and education (0.8 per cent).

CSSS has not identified even a small service area to focus on in six of the fifteen groups of services included in the TISMOS report accounting for roughly 40 per cent of global services export. These six areas are